



Mount Olive Baseball & Softball Association Code of Conduct / “Three Strikes” Policy

Code of Conduct Background / Expectations:

MOBSA supports and asks that all players, coaches, parents, and spectators abide by Mount Olive Recreation Departments Code of Conduct [www.mountolivetwpnj.org/media/1971]. This Code of Conduct is also referenced in the MOBSA By-Laws and consent to the policy must be acknowledged during the player and coach registration process each season.

- The goal of this policy is to ensure everyone upholds our core values and contribute to a positive and enriching experience for all participants. Communication and collaboration between coaches, parents, and MOBSA are crucial.
- This policy is not exhaustive and may be modified at the discretion of the MOBSA Board.
- Actions or incidents in violation of this Code of Conduct will be reviewed by the MOBSA Board on an ad-hoc basis. Reports of any infractions by players, coaches, spectators, or any other individuals must be communicated and documented in writing.
- The severity of the consequences are intended to consider the nature of the infraction, prior behavior / history, and impact on the program and participants.
- While rare, MOBSA may ban the presence of a person at a youth sports event in accordance with certain guidelines found on the State of New Jersey pursuant to the provisions of P.L. 2002, Chapter 74, [www.mountolivetwpnj.org/media/1956]

General Overview of MOBSA “Three-Strike Policy”:

MOBSA utilizes a three-strike policy to address infractions. The severity of the consequence will increase with each subsequent offense. Some offenses or repeat offenses may also come with additional penalties, suspensions, or removal from the program.

Strike 1: Minor infractions: Disrespectful behavior towards players, parents, or officials, minor rule violations, inappropriate language.

Strike 2: Second infraction OR more serious infractions, such as aggressive behavior towards players, coaches, spectators or umpires, use of discriminatory language, failure to follow safety protocols.

Strike 3: Third infractions OR severe infraction such as physical violence, harassment, discrimination, serious rule violations, violation of league policies, endangering player safety.

Accumulation of three strikes in any calendar year will result in the removal of the player/participant from participating or attending MOBSA events for the remainder of the season.

Common Infractions / Pre-Determined Punishments:

Physical assault of any player, coach, spectator or umpire	3 strikes
Engaging in or encouraging the use of profanity around children	Initial offense: Verbal warning Subsequent offense: 1 Strike
Abusive language, gestures, or threats made in front of or toward players, coaches, spectators, or umpires, or deliberately inciting unsportsmanlike behavior.	1 strike
Ejection from a game	1 strike and a 2 game suspension
Allowing participation of any player, coach, or spectator who is ineligible for any reason	1 strike
Insubordination or refusing to obey instructions or guidelines properly issued by MOBSA or the Mt. Olive Recreation Dept.	1 strike
Any spectator entering the field of play and disrupting a practice or game	1 strikes and a 2 game suspension
Theft, damaging or attempting to damage equipment or facilities utilized by MOBSA	1 strike and may incur replacement costs, where necessary
Deliberately throwing or kicking of equipment in an aggressive, disrespectful, or unsportsmanlike manner	Initial offense: Verbal warning Subsequent offense: 1 Strike
Any behavior or actions which may be deemed dangerous, violent, inciteful of violence, unruly, disruptive, offensive, indecent or obscene toward another person including, but not limited to on account of that person's race, color, religion, national origin, gender, age, sexual orientation or disability.	1 strike
Engaging, or encouraging children and others, in any behavior which may reasonably endanger the physical or emotional health, safety and/or well-being of any player, coach, spectator, or umpire	1 strike

Appeal Process:

Any person receiving notification of any warnings, strikes, or penalties from MOBSA and who wishes to appeal must do so within seven calendar days of their notice by forwarding a written request for appeal. The appeal should specifically outline the basis of such person's contest of the notice of violation. In the event any notice of violation is not appealed within seven days of such notice, all actions and determinations taken by MOBSA shall become final.

Upon receipt of any appeal, MOBSA shall offer a hearing within seven days of the appeal date and provide an opportunity for said person and any interested person or persons to appear and be heard with respect to the occurrence of any violation and action taken. MOBSA shall review statements, first-hand accounts and any other pertinent information or documentation relevant to the violation and may sustain, overturn or modify the notice of violation consistent with this Code of Conduct.

The appeal process is specific to MOBSA. MOBSA may or may not entertain appeals of any temporary, limited or immediate enforcement imposed on participants/persons by other associations unaffiliated with MOBSA (e.g. an individual is suspended by an outside organization such as USABL, Cal Ripken, Babe Ruth, etc).